

Maintaining balance

Smartphones and tablets are changing the way we interact with each other. Though they can be helpful and convenient, it is important to develop good habits when using them.

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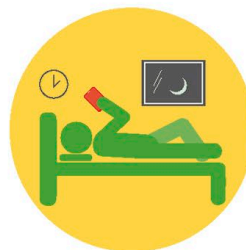
Setting boundaries

With technology and computers embedded in so many different things these days, it is becoming increasingly difficult to set boundaries on our interaction with digital devices. Aside from sometimes being impolite, overuse of digital devices can lead to physical pain and affect sleep. It is useful to try some simple steps in order to limit the potential downside of digital devices.



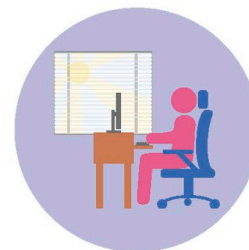
△ Short breaks

Looking at screens for long periods can cause eye and muscle strain. Going for a short walk or simply focusing your eyes on something else for a bit can help.



△ Night-time use

Studies have shown that using screens right before bedtime can affect your sleep patterns, so try to avoid them for an hour before you turn in.



△ Longer term

Improving your environment is important if you need to use screens a lot. Plenty of light, and comfortable furniture and peripherals can help.

Problems and solutions

Having a wealth of information and potential entertainment at our fingertips can unsurprisingly be incredibly distracting. The world wide web never sleeps: there is an almost infinite amount of things to be notified about, and to interact with. This can lead to problems when people prioritize their online life over their real-world existence, or when they experience emotional upset based on their experiences online. Here are some common problems and possible solutions.

Problems



Distraction

Being unable to focus on conversations, school, lectures, or work for long periods may be a sign of someone allowing their digital devices to take precedence over real-world connections.



Narcissism

Frequently posting selfies or status updates on social media is often a sign of someone with an unhealthy obsession with themselves.

Solutions



Break the habit

Try to have device-free periods, especially when interacting with others or when your full attention is needed. Change your notification settings so that you receive less of them.



“Do I need to post?”

Take a minute to ask yourself what you are trying to achieve every time you post something. Is the information important? Is social media the right avenue for it? Is it of interest to your audience?

“Technology is a good servant but a bad master.”

Gretchen Rubin (b. 1965),
American author